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C H A P T E R O N E

A H M A D N A G A R F O R T

T w e n t y M o n t h s

Ahmadnagar Fort, 13th April 1944

IT IS MORE THAN TWENTY MONTHS SINCE WE WERE BROUGHT HERE,

more than twenty months of my ninth term of imprisonment.

T h e new moon, a shimmering crescent in the darkening sky, greeted us on our arrival here. The bright fortnight of the waxing moon had begun. Ever since then each coming of the new moon has been a reminder to me that another month of my imprisonment is over. So it was with my last term of imprisonment which began with the new moon, just after the *Deepavali,* the festival of light. T h e moon, ever a companion to me in prison, has grown more friendly with closer acquaintance, a reminder of the loveliness of this world, of the waxing and waning of life, of light